

MIZORAM PUBLIC SERVICE COMMISSION
COMPETITIVE EXAMINATION FOR CHILD DEVELOPMENT PROJECT
OFFICER (CDPO) UNDER SOCIAL WELFARE, WOMEN & CHILD
DEVELOPMENT DEPARTMENT
&
ASSISTANT DIRECTOR (FOOD & DRUGS) UNDER HEALTH & FAMILY
WELFARE DEPARTMENT, GOVERNMENT OF MIZORAM.
(NOVEMBER, 2025)

(GENERAL ENGLISH)

Time Allowed : 3 hours

FM : 100

SECTION - A (Conventional Type) (34 Marks)

*This Section should be answered only on the Answer Sheet provided.
Marks for each question is indicated against it.*

1. Write a precis of the following passage, giving it a suitable title: (14)

Communication is an essential requirement for all human performance and interaction. It welds individuals into groups by developing common interests, by crystallising common concepts, by establishing relationships, by extending cooperation, by sharing experience and by establishing a common heritage. The underlying principle of each of these acts is that we use language as a means of communication. In a much broader sense, language is a tool of communication, but aside from language, there is also another important, but often overlooked means of communication.

When we talk about language as a means of communication, we mean the usage of language and words— how they sound, how they are formed, their meaning, and their structure. However, we do not use just words or language to communicate. Non-verbal communication— our body movements, our expressions and our gestures - convey so much more than we are aware of. In fact, it is often said that a person may lie with their words, but their bodies reveal the truth. When someone's body language is inconsistent with their words, we tend to believe the body language rather than the words. Thus, both these means of communication— verbal and non-verbal, are both essential in effective communication.

For example, a person may say that they are interested in what we are talking about, but if they fidget constantly, or their eyes keep darting away, or their legs are angled away from us, their body movements convey that they are either distracted, or they are not interested in what we have to say. This is why, to excel in communication, it is important to focus on both what we are saying, but on what our bodies are conveying. A pleasant facial expression, open gestures, and correct posture suggests that you are confident, honest and invested in what you are trying to express. No matter the content of the speech, if the speaker just drones on without making eye contact with the audience, or he crosses his arms, the audience will find it hard to fully connect with him or what he is saying. The most effective communication, therefore, incorporates the skillful usage of both verbal and non-verbal means of communication.

2. Read the following passage carefully and answer the questions that follow:-

From the wealth of science we have selected certain parts. And our choice has in no way been influenced by a consideration of the higher interest of humanity. It has simply followed the path of our natural tendencies. The principles of the greatest convenience and of the least effort, the pleasure to be had from speed, change, and comfort, and also the burning need of escaping from ourselves, are the driving force in the success of new inventions. But no one has ever stopped to ask how we would cope with the enormous acceleration of the pace of life resulting from rapid transportation, telegraph, telephone, modern business methods, machines that write and calculate, and those that do all the housekeeping drudgery of former times. Steam-heated houses, electric lighting, elevators, and the chemical doctoring and adulteration of foodstuffs have been accepted lock, stock, and barrel, their comprehensive adoption being solely precipitated by the hedonic and facilitative advantages they confer. Nevertheless, no account whatsoever has been taken of their probable effect on human beings.

In the organization of industrial life, the influence of the factory upon the physiological and mental state of the workers has been left by the wayside. Modern industry is based on the conception of the maximum production at lowest cost so that an individual or a group of individuals may rake in as much money as possible. It has expanded without any idea of the true nature of the human beings who run the machines, and without giving a second thought to the effect produced on the individuals and on their descendants by the artificial mode of existence imposed by the factory. The great cities have been built with no regard for us. The shape and dimensions of the skyscrapers hinge entirely on the necessity of obtaining the maximum income per square foot of ground, and of offering to the tenants' offices and apartments that please them. This caused the construction of gigantic buildings where far too many human beings are crammed together. Civilized men have a taste for such a way of living. While they soak up the comfort and banal luxury of their dwelling, they do not realise that they are missing out on the necessities of life. A modern city consists of monstrous edifices and of dark, narrow streets chock-full of gasoline fumes, coal dust and toxic gases, shattered by the noise of the taxi cabs, trucks, and trolleys, and swarming ceaselessly with great crowds. Obviously, it has not been planned for the good of its inhabitants.

Our life is influenced to a great extent by commercial advertising. Such publicity is undertaken purely and simply in the interest of the advertisers and not of the consumers. For example, the public has been hoodwinked into believing that white bread is better than brown. Consequently, flour has been treated more and more thoroughly and thus stripped of its most useful components. Such treatment allows for its preservation for longer periods and facilitates the making of bread. The millers and the bakers line their pockets. The consumers eat an inferior product, under the impression that it is a superior one. And in the countries where bread is the principal food, the population goes downhill. Enormous amounts of money are poured into publicity. As a result, large quantities of pharmaceutical products that are at the least useless, and often harmful, have become the norm for civilized men. In this manner, the raw greed of individuals sufficiently shrewd to whip up a popular demand for the goods that they have for sale calls the shots in the modern world.

- (i) According to the passage, why have modern inventions and industrial developments been widely adopted without considering their effects on human beings? (2)
- (ii) Why does the author criticize modern industry's approach to production? (2)
- (iii) According to the passage, what role does greed play in the modern world? (2)
- (iv) What is the meaning of the phrase 'accepted lock, stock, and barrel' used in the passage? (2)
 - (a) Accepted slowly and tentatively.
 - (b) Accepted with minor alterations and exceptions.
 - (c) Accepted completely, including all its parts or details.
 - (d) Accepted only the beneficial parts of the innovation.

- (v) What is the meaning of the idiom 'calls the shots' in the final paragraph? (2)
- (a) To make suggestions or give advice.
 - (b) To receive orders from a higher authority.
 - (c) To be the person or group in control and making the decisions.
 - (d) To publicly advertise products and services.
3. Imagine you're the Child Development Project Officer (CDPO) of a Rural Development Block. You have recently conducted a survey and found a significant increase in malnutrition among children aged 0-5. Draft a formal letter to the Director, Women & Child Development, outlining the urgent need for a special nutritional supplement program in your Block. In the letter, detail the key findings of your survey, propose specific actions to address the issue, and request the allocation of necessary funds and resources. (10)

SECTION - B (Multiple Choice questions) (66 Marks)

All questions carry equal mark of 1 each. Attempt all questions.

*This Section should be answered only on the **OMR Response Sheet** provided.*

Direction (Question Nos. 1-10): Identify the parts of speech in the underlined words:

1. There is a party next week though I don't think I can go.
 - (a) Preposition
 - (b) Conjunction
 - (c) Adverb
 - (d) Adjectives
2. She is very uninclined to read the manuscript.
 - (a) Adjective
 - (b) Adverb
 - (c) Preposition
 - (d) Pronoun
3. Well, I don't know about that.
 - (a) Conjunction
 - (b) Adjective
 - (c) Interjection
 - (d) Adverb
4. What a piece of work is man!
 - (a) Adverb
 - (b) Conjunction
 - (c) Adjective
 - (d) Preposition
5. He proclaimed his love for Estella in front of everyone.
 - (a) Noun
 - (b) Adjective
 - (c) Verb
 - (d) Preposition
6. I do not simply love, you, I worship and adore you.
 - (a) Adjective
 - (b) Verb
 - (c) Adverb
 - (d) Noun
7. Puia himself stood up and spoke in favour of the proposal, but it was of no use.
 - (a) Adverb
 - (b) Noun
 - (c) Adjective
 - (d) Pronoun
8. He had joined the office two years before his father died.
 - (a) Conjunction
 - (b) Interjection
 - (c) Adjective
 - (d) Preposition

9. I won't leave until you are ready.
(a) Conjunction (b) Adverb
(c) Preposition (d) Adjective
10. I wish I had a million dollars.
(a) Verb (b) Interjection
(c) Noun (d) Pronoun

Direction (Question Nos. 11- 20): Fill in the blanks with the appropriate preposition/ adverb:

11. Go, and run _____; we shall call you when it is time to come in.
(a) on (b) about
(c) in (d) across
12. Many years _____, I met a man who told me my fortune.
(a) since (b) hence
(c) ago (d) then
13. The examination will commence _____ 6th November.
(a) at (b) on
(c) by (d) in
14. He is late; _____, we shall start without him.
(a) finally (b) whereas
(c) consequently (d) provided
15. I had no time to warn you. _____, I wasn't sure.
(a) besides (b) aside
(c) beside (d) asides
16. Do this in accordance _____ the directions you have received.
(a) to (b) for
(c) of (d) with
17. We must treat everyone equally, irrespective _____ race, class or gender.
(a) on (b) to
(c) by (d) of
18. I shall be back _____ 11:00 a.m. today.
(a) within (b) in
(c) by (d) on
19. He swore upon the sky _____ his head that he will not betray me.
(a) over (b) on
(c) upon (d) above
20. The man died _____ cholera, leaving behind his wife and two children.
(a) by (b) of
(c) from (d) with

Direction(Question Nos. 21- 26): *In each sentence given below, there is an underlined group of words. You are required to identify that underlined part of each sentence by choosing the correct options given below each sentence.*

21. She refused to believe that he could win the tournament.
(a) Noun clause (b) Adjective Clause
(c) Adverbial Clause (d) noun phrase
22. To err is human, but to forgive is divine.
(a) Adverbial Phrase (b) Adjective phrase
(c) Noun phrase (d) Adjective clause
23. The book that you gave me was fascinating.
(a) Noun clause (b) Adverbial clause
(c) Adverb phrase (d) Adjective clause
24. The man wearing a red hat is my uncle.
(a) Noun Clause (b) Adverb Phrase
(c) Adjective phrase (d) Adjective clause
25. Tell me what happened yesterday.
(a) Noun Clause (b) Adjective Clause
(c) Adverb Clause (d) Adverb Phrase
26. She took time off for a much needed vacation.
(a) Adverb phrase (b) Noun phrase
(c) adverb clause (d) adjective clause

Direction(Question Nos. 27- 31): *Choose the correct option to transform the sentences as directed, without changing their meaning:*

27. I was not at all sure of your success. (to Affirmative)
(a) I was sure of your success (b) I was doubtful of your success
(c) I was at all sure of your success (d) I was unenthusiastic of your success
28. O that I may see her again! (to Assertive)
(a) O I wish that I may see her again. (b) That I may see her again.
(c) I wonder if I will see her again. (d) I wish that I may see her again.
29. How can I bear it any longer? (to Assertive)
(a) I can bear it no longer (b) It is asked if I can bear it any longer
(c) I would not bear it no longer (d) It is too hard to bear
30. It is possible that I may have been mistaken. (to Negative)
(a) It is not possible that I may have been mistaken
(b) It is possible that I may have not been mistaken
(c) It is impossible that I may have been mistaken
(d) It is not impossible that I may have been mistaken
31. It is sad that children are the victims of war. (to Exclamatory)
(a) Alas! that children are the victims of war! (b) Pooh! That children are the victims of war!
(c) O that children may be the victims of war! (d) What victims of war children are!

Direction (Question Nos. 32 - 36): Choose the correct option and change the following sentences as directed:

32. The maid said, "The boy was hiding in a closet." (to Indirect)
(a) The maid said that the boy was hiding in a closet.
(b) The maid said that the boy hid in a closet
(c) The maid said that the boy had been hiding in a closet.
(d) The maid said that the boy had hid in a closet.
33. He told me that he had not seen Mary since the previous day. (to Direct)
(a) He told me, "I had not seen Mary since the previous day."
(b) He said to me, "I have not seen Mary since yesterday."
(c) He tells to me "I had not seen Mary since the previous day."
(d) He said, "He had not seen Mary since the previous day."
34. She said to Peter, "Give me your book, please" (to Indirect)
(a) She said to Peter that give her his book please.
(b) She requested Peter to give her his book.
(c) She told Peter to give her his book please.
(d) She asked Peter to give me your book.
35. The teacher said that the earth revolves around the sun. (to Direct)
(a) The teacher said, "The earth revolves around the sun."
(b) The teacher said, "the earth revolved around the sun."
(c) The teacher says, "The earth revolve around the sun."
(d) The teacher said, "The earth has revolved around the sun."
36. Siami said, "Rama called me up this morning." (to Indirect)
(a) Siami said that Rama called me up this morning.
(b) Siami said that Rama called her up this morning.
(c) Siami said that Rama called her up that morning.
(d) Siami said that Rama had called her up that morning.

Direction (Question Nos. 37-43): Choose the most appropriate word given below each sentences to fill in the blanks:

37. He is a _____, therefore, he never drinks.
(a) teetotaler (b) teeter-totter
(c) tattle-tale (d) totalitarian
38. He has been found _____ for this post due to canvassing.
(a) ineligible (b) indelible
(c) inedible (d) intelligible
39. In a _____ gesture, she donated the prize money to charity.
(a) bellicose (b) voluminous
(c) magnanimous (d) maleficent
40. Jack was the _____ of elegance and class.
(a) epigram (b) epitome
(c) epicenter (d) epilogue

41. The country was a _____, ruled by a queen.
(a) matricide (b) matrilineal
(c) matrimony (d) monarchy
42. He is a(n) _____ who hates anyone practicing a different religion.
(a) atheist (b) racist
(c) bigot (d) infidel
43. You must consult only _____ sources for your research.
(a) credible (b) conceivable
(c) incredible (d) inconceivable

Directions (Qusetion Nos. 44-46): Each item in this section has a sentence with three underlined parts labelled as (a), (b) & (c). Read each sentence to determined whether there is an error in any part of each sentence and indicate your response on the answer sheet by choosing either (a) or (b) or (c) or (d). If there is no error, indicate your sesponse as (d).

44. I enjoyed / during my / stay in England. / No error .
(a) (b) (c) (d)
45. They appointed / him as a manager / as he is efficient. / No error.
(a) (b) (c) (d)
46. Mr. Sharma is planning / to settle in Delhi / as soon as he will retire in Apil next year. / No error
(a) (b) (c) (d)

Directions (Qusetion Nos.47-56): Fill in the blanks with the appropriate form of the verbs given in brackets:

47. We _____ (drive) all the way to the resort, only for it to be closed.
(a) drive (b) were driving
(c) drove (d) will drive
48. It _____ (rain) when he came over this morning.
(a) has rained (b) rains
(c) is raining (d) was raining
49. She _____ (work) in this office since 2000.
(a) will work (b) will be working
(c) has been working (d) had worked
50. The teacher _____ (want) to see you immediately.
(a) wants (b) is wanting
(c) want (d) wanted
51. You must _____ (complete) this assignment today itself.
(a) completes (b) complete
(c) completed (d) completing
52. I _____ (wear) a white dress on my wedding day.
(a) will have worn (b) will wear
(c) will have been wearing (d) will worn

53. She _____ (sit) there waiting for you for over an hour.
(a) sits (b) had sat
(c) has been sitting (d) was sitting
54. She _____ (go) for a walk every evening.
(a) go (b) goes
(c) went (d) gone
55. I _____ (hope) for a promotion at work this year.
(a) am hoping (b) hoped
(c) have hoped (d) will hope
56. He _____ (prefer) his wife to stay at home.
(a) prefer (b) is preferring
(c) prefers (d) has preferred

Directions (Question Nos.57- 61): Choose the correct word to connect the following sentences:

57. The triangles are congruent; _____ they are equal.
(a) but (b) hence
(c) otherwise (d) still
58. In an unjust society, the corrupt prosper _____ the honest stay poor.
(a) while (b) so
(c) when (d) therefore
59. I shall do it _____ you asked me to.
(a) when (b) so that
(c) before (d) since
60. You may have a cookie _____ you finish your vegetables first.
(a) provided (b) though
(c) unless (d) until
61. I shall help him _____ he does not deserve it.
(a) though (b) for
(c) since (d) if

Directions (Question Nos. 62- 66): Choose the most appropriate meaning for the following idioms and phrases.

62. A lone wolf
(a) One who is very violent (b) A very clumsy person
(c) one who prefers to live alone (d) one who casts the deciding vote
63. A rule of thumb
(a) A rough estimate or measurement (b) A majority decision
(c) A nonsensical statement (d) By a small amount
64. To be close-fisted
(a) To attack someone (b) To lack warmth or affection
(c) To keep a secret (d) To be miserly

65. Up to one's elbows

- (a) Deeply involved in something
- (c) In great suspense

- (b) Pay no attention to something
- (d) To feel discouraged

66. To hold one's tongue

- (a) To flatter someone
- (c) To lie blatantly

- (b) To keep silent
- (d) To argue with someone

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